

Participant Information Sheet

Participant Information Sheet - Survey

Project title:	A visualisation to help school students understand how Large Language Models work
Principal investigator:	Prof Judy Robertson– Judy.Robertson@ed.ac.uk
Researcher collecting data:	Xinyao Liao – s2810619@ed.ac.uk
Funder (if applicable):	n/a

Please take time to read the following information carefully. You should keep this page for your records.

Who are the researchers?

The researcher collecting data is Xinyao Liao, an MSc student at the School of Informatics, University of Edinburgh. The study is supervised by Prof Judy Robertson, who serves as the Principal Investigator (PI).

What is the purpose of the study?

The purpose of this study is to evaluate an interactive educational website designed to help school students understand how Large Language Models (LLMs), such as ChatGPT, work.

The study aims to investigate whether the website is easy to use, engaging, and effective at explaining key concepts about Large Language Models. Feedback collected from participants will be used to improve the website and support the researcher's MSc dissertation.

Why have I been asked to take part?

You have been invited because you are aged 18 or over. Adult participants are invited to evaluate the educational website and provide feedback on its usability, clarity and educational value before it is evaluated with younger users.

Do I have to take part?

No – participation in this study is entirely up to you. You may withdraw from the study at any time, up until one month after completing the study, without giving a reason. After this point, personal data will be deleted and anonymised data will be combined such that it is impossible to remove individual information from the analysis. Your rights will not be affected. If you wish to withdraw, please contact the Principal Investigator. We will keep copies of your original consent and your withdrawal request.

What will happen if I decide to take part?



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If you decide to take part in this study:

- You will be asked to use an interactive educational website designed to explain how Large Language Models (LLMs), such as ChatGPT, work.
- After using the website, you will be asked to complete an online questionnaire about your experience, including your opinions on the clarity, usability and educational value of the website.
- Completing the website activities and questionnaire should take approximately 20–30 minutes.
- The questionnaire will be shared with you online through Microsoft Forms.
- No interviews, audio recordings, video recordings or photographs will be taken.

Are there any risks associated with taking part?

There are no significant risks associated with participation.

Are there any benefits associated with taking part?

Although there are no direct personal benefits, your feedback will help improve educational resources designed to teach young people about Large Language Models and artificial intelligence.

What will happen to the results of this study?

The results of this study may be summarised in the researcher's MSc dissertation, academic publications, reports and presentations. Quotes or key findings will be anonymised. We will remove any information that could, in our assessment, allow anyone to identify you. With your consent, anonymised information may also be used in future ethically approved research. Your anonymised data may be archived for a maximum of three years. All potentially identifiable data will be deleted within this time frame if it has not already been deleted as part of anonymisation.

Data protection and confidentiality

Your data will be processed in accordance with Data Protection Law. All information collected about you will be kept strictly confidential. Your data will be referred to by a unique participant number rather than by name. Your data will only be viewed by the research team: Xinyao Liao and Prof Judy Robertson.

All electronic data will be stored on a password-protected encrypted computer, on the School of Informatics' secure file servers, or on the University's secure encrypted cloud storage services (DataShare, ownCloud or SharePoint). No paper records will be created. Your consent information will be kept separately from your responses in order to minimise risk.

What are my data protection rights?



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The University of Edinburgh is a Data Controller for the information you provide. You have the right to access information held about you. Your right of access can be exercised in accordance with Data Protection Law. You also have other rights including rights of correction, erasure and objection. For more details, including the right to lodge a complaint with the Information Commissioner's Office, please visit www.ico.org.uk. Questions, comments and requests about your personal data can also be sent to the University Data Protection Officer at dpo@ed.ac.uk.

Who can I contact?

If you have any further questions about the study, please contact the researcher collecting data, Xinyao Liao, at s2810619@ed.ac.uk.

If you wish to make a complaint about the study, please contact **inf-eth-ics@inf.ed.ac.uk**. When you contact us, please provide the study title and detail the nature of your complaint.

Updated information

If the research project changes in any way, an updated Participant Information Sheet will be made available to participants.

Alternative formats

To request this document in an alternative format, such as large print or on coloured paper, please contact Xinyao Liao at s2810619@ed.ac.uk.

General information

For general information about how we use your data, go to:

<https://research-office.ed.ac.uk/about/privacy-notice>

Thank you for taking the time to read this.

If you decide to take part, please complete the attached consent form before beginning the study.

